

JACK SENECHAL

ENGINEERING LEADER · PLATFORM, QUALITY & DELIVERY

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SUMMARY

Engineering leader with **6+ years building and leading teams**, hands-on with the platforms those teams ship, and a record of turning fragile systems and depleted teams into reliable ones.

- **Team and org building:** recruited and rebuilt teams from scratch, led engineers and managers across the SDLC, and **grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles**.
- **Quality and reliability at scale:** established the metrics, monitoring, and testing discipline that **reduced platform errors and incidents ~100x**, and executed a **zero-downtime migration to Kubernetes** with its databases.
- **Cloud, containerization, CI/CD:** transitioned a large legacy codebase to cloud-native Infrastructure-as-Code and **led an org-wide DevOps culture transformation** whose standards were adopted across product teams.
- **SDLC maturation as machinery, not memos:** CI gates, independent review, and process metrics that hold up under load, most recently applied to agent-driven “software factories.”
- **Executive and cross-functional partner:** aligns engineering roadmaps with business strategy, keeps leadership informed, and consults across departments on technical solutions and ROI.

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant · AI-Native Software Delivery

Client engagements | May 2026 - Present | Remote

- **Running “software factories”:** agent-driven delivery pipelines that carry engineering work from spec to shipped, with the human in the product seat.
- **Core thesis:** the same DevOps and project-management discipline that makes human teams work is also the necessary and sufficient foundation for agent teams, encoded into the harness and context.
- **GitHub as the coordination substrate:** issues, PRs, and Projects are the single ledger.
- **Harness-enforced SDLC:** PRs gated by an independent fresh-context reviewer, green CI, supply-chain scanning, migration governance, and a deployment smoke check, with regular review of which process steps and artifacts still earn their place.
- **Self-improving harness:** orchestration agents tasked with running, observing, and refining the process, converging on refinements and shipping them under human-in-the-loop gates.
- **Human in the product role:** defining and prioritizing work, verifying against deployed previews, steering product and process.

Co-founder & Fractional CTO

Building Humane Technology | June 2025 - Present | Remote (part-time)

- **Originated and co-architected HumaneBench.ai**, an open-source AI evaluation framework built on AISI Inspect. **Python**.
- Acting as **fractional CTO to the team** that built it out to a published, externally usable product, shaping architecture, scoring design, and multi-provider support, and guiding documentation and positioning.
- Extending the framework toward **real-time evaluation**: built a **low-latency proof-of-concept classifier** that scores model behavior against HumaneBench rubrics inline at **sub-100ms** and can sit in a production request path rather than run only in batch.
- Designing **telemetry for operational visibility**, and evaluation feedback loops to inform system-prompt iteration and model fine-tuning.
- Owning **technical product direction and roadmap**: production monitoring, multi-turn evaluation, and adoption maturity models.

Co-founder & Software Engineer

Alchemy Astrology (formerly Mirror Astrology) | Nov 2024 - Jul 2026 | Remote

- Owned front-end development: Ruby on Rails views, JavaScript, HTML+CSS, Tailwind, responsive UI/UX.
- Led design and UX delivery, working with freelance designers and translating their designs into the Rails framework.
- Collaborated on back-end development: Stripe integration, SSO authentication, Rails MVC.
- Collaborated closely with co-founders on product direction, Figma design, UX, roadmap planning, and prioritization.

Infrastructure Engineer

Tobiko | Mar 2024 - Oct 2024 | Remote

- Architected and implemented a scalable cloud platform serving customer workloads at a fast-paced startup.
- Built CI/CD patterns including mono-repo conditional workflows, workload identity federation, and continuous delivery.
- Implemented a Slack-based customer support and incident response platform; onboarded teammates and customers.
- Python, Pulumi, GCP, GKE, Cloud Run, CircleCI, Helm, SQLMesh.

Engineering Manager / Principal Software Engineer

Mavenlink / Kantata | Apr 2017 - Dec 2023 | San Francisco, CA

- **Infrastructure & Reliability Platform** (4 years): Recruited and built a new platform team from scratch after mass departures left two engineers, then **led the organization's DevOps culture transformation**, defining the reliability, on-call, CI/CD, and testing standards adopted across product teams. Owned the platform roadmap, requirements triage, and priority management while staying hands-on with architecture and code review. Transitioned a large legacy codebase to cloud-native Infrastructure-as-Code (Terraform, Ansible, Kubernetes).
- **M-Bridge Integration Platform** (2 years): Led the team that stabilized and scaled Kantata's own integrations platform, connecting the SaaS to customer systems with multi-system data orchestration. **Established the operational metrics and monitoring that reduced errors and incidents by ~100x** and turned a chronic source of escalations into a dependable foundation. Executed a zero-downtime migration to Kubernetes including relational, document, and cache databases.
- **BI Data Pipeline** (3 months): Led a transition team to take ownership of and improve the analytics data pipeline. Migrated the pipeline to Kubernetes.
- **Organization-wide leadership**: Set engineering standards and drove change management across the eng org, partnering with leadership on hiring, performance reviews, and process. **Grew multiple junior engineers into senior SWE and Engineering Manager roles** and mentored engineers across teams. **Top Performer Award, 2021.**

Lead Developer, Co-founder

Pegg | 2014 - 2017 | San Francisco, CA

- Designed, architected, and built a cross-platform mobile app from scratch (iOS/Android). Node.js backend, JS/Phonegap frontend, Firebase real-time systems, CI/CD to AWS/CloudFront via CircleCI.
- Established engineering workflow: pair programming, automated testing (Karma/Chai), continuous integration, and rapid deployment processes.
- Co-led product strategy, monetization, and launch planning.

Earlier Career (2001 - 2014)

- **Consultant & Entrepreneur** (2008 - 2014): Founded OpenTest Pro (automated testing education). Built e-commerce ordering system for Turnbull & Asser shirtmakers. Full-stack consulting in Ruby on Rails, Node.js, D3 data visualization. Rapid prototyping and client delivery.
- **Web Developer, OnForce, Inc** (2006 - 2007): Introduced automated testing and CI. Built comprehensive API test suite. Integrated platform with Salesforce APIs.
- **Development Lead, JBA Network** (2003 - 2006): Lead programmer and project manager for mynewsletterbuilder.com. Architected the initial release, then built and scaled the development team.

OPEN SOURCE PROJECTS

Scan MCP (2024 - Present)

MCP (Model Context Protocol) server for scanner automation and document digitization. Privacy-first architecture with smart device discovery, JSON Schema validation, and support for both local stdio and network HTTP transports. TypeScript/Node.js.

github.com/jacksenechal/scan-mcp

HumaneBench (2024 - Present)

Evaluation framework for measuring human-friendly behavior in AI assistants, built on AISI Inspect. Tests AI responses across humane technology principles including loneliness, mental health, transparency, and privacy. Supports multiple LLM providers with extensible scenario datasets. Python.

SKILLS

- **Languages & Frameworks:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python, Ruby on Rails, Node.js, Bash.
- **Front-end:** React, Vue, HTML, CSS, Tailwind, Responsive Design, UI/UX.
- **Back-end & Data:** API Design, Microservices, Distributed Systems, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis.
- **Cloud & Infrastructure:** AWS, Google Cloud Platform, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, Ansible, Pulumi, Helm.
- **CI/CD & DevOps:** CircleCI, GitHub Actions, Automated Testing, Regression Suites, TDD, Infrastructure as Code, Cloud-Native Architecture, Cloud Migration.
- **Platform & Reliability:** Platform Engineering, SRE, SLOs & Error Budgets, Incident Response, On-Call Practices, Observability & Monitoring, Quality Metrics.
- **AI/LLM:** MCP (Model Context Protocol), chatbot development, prompt engineering, context augmentation.
- **Leadership:** Team Building, Developing Managers & Engineers, Performance Management, Hiring, Roadmap Ownership, Executive Communication, Cross-Functional Collaboration, SDLC Process Improvement, Agile/Scrum/Kanban, Change Management.

EDUCATION

BA in Mathematics, minor in Computer Science

University of North Carolina at Asheville | May 2003

- Graduated with distinction in Mathematics. Undergraduate research in 4D fractals.

RECOMMENDATIONS

“Jack is an **exceptional engineer and leader**. He strives to **deeply understand the technology** he’s working on while remaining cognizant of the socio-technical components that may be a factor in any project. He’s thorough, detail-oriented, and outcome-oriented, which means **the solutions he architects, builds, and collaborates on come out better**. Jack also strives to be **at the forefront of new technology** and assess how he can leverage it. Newer tech like GenAI can be complex and ever-evolving, and **Jack is not one to back down but step up and embrace**. He does all this with a **strong team mentality**, is a phenomenal team player, and can **effectively delegate to help lift others’ skill sets**.”

— *Brandon Clifford, Director of DevOps, Kantata*

“Jack has **had quite a profound impact on my career**. As a young engineer, I was fortunate enough to work with Jack as my coach. He served as a great mentor, helping me build both technical and professional skills and **forming me into the engineer that I am today**. Throughout our time together, Jack was caring and invested in helping me set goals and develop my career. **His mentorship was a key factor in elevating myself from an incoming Junior Engineer to an Engineering Manager**. Jack has a great curiosity and a strong set of technical capabilities that allow him to serve as a great example for others and a key contributor to any team!”

— *Wesley Morlock, Engineering Director, Kantata*

“Jack is a fantastic engineer always ready to **help solve problems and more importantly, teach you how to solve them**. He guided me and my team through a bunch of challenging GitOps situations with patience and kindness, leading by example. Always diligent with his work, willing to roll up his sleeves to get things done and **find creative solutions**. Everyone would be lucky to have someone like him in their teams!”

— *Cesar Palafox Garza, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata*

“Jack is **awesome at understanding the direction teams need to go to make important improvements in Kantata’s Engineering organization as a whole**. He has been instrumental in building and implementing strategies to upgrade Ruby, Rails, and React. If I had any questions about infrastructure and Kubernetes he would be able to answer and **provide solid explanations to the entire team**.”

— *Justin Hurstwright, Principal Software Engineer, Kantata*

See additional recommendations on LinkedIn